

festival

Glory of Gurus

DELHI Speak of SPIC-MACAY and there's always a heart-warming tale. One of the finest movements in India, which has infused in the youth a love for music, dance and Indian culture, has earned itself a universal appeal. Be it San Francisco, Bangalore or the rural areas of Rajasthan, there's a sense of cultural awakening and pride it evokes. "What is important is the organisation has not only focused on the artistes but the art as well. Artistes come and go but the message of art should reach people," says Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma, the santoor maestro.

The response of the audience is overwhelming. "I went to a remote school in Chipra Mahu village near Kanpur. People were thirsty for good music. We need to quench this thirst," says Sunanda Sharma, vocalist and disciple of Girija Devi. In its 31st year now, SPIC-MACAY is beginning its Virasat 2008 series in the Capital and 300 towns all

over India.

The festival will begin with a recital by Devi and Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia at the Viceregal Lodge, University of Delhi. Among the other artistes are Pandit Birju Maharaj, Alarmel Valli, Pandit Vishwamohan Bhatt, Shovana Narayan, Pandit Rajan and Sajan Mishra and Teejan Bai. Virasat 2008 will comprise various aspects of Indian heritage including theatre by Habib Tanvir, film classics of directors like Satyajit Ray, Akira Kurosawa and Charlie Chaplin. There will be folk forms from the North-east, Sufi Qawwali, Biraha Geet by Ram Kailas, Prahlad Natak by Krishan Chandra Sahu, heritage walks to historical sites, craft workshops by Sentila Yanger (Naga weaving), Shanti Devi (Madhubani), Karuna Chitrakar (Patwa painting) and Anis Siddiqui (calligraphy). These programmes will be held in schools and colleges. The event is dedicated to Guru Ammannur Madhav Chakyar and Pandit Kishan Maharaj. From September 2 to December. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**

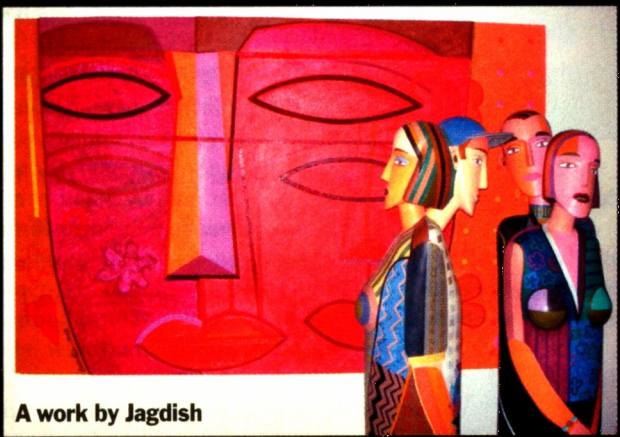
DANCE OF LIFE: Madhvi Mudgal (left) and Alarmel Valli



art exhibition

A Curios Sensation

MUMBAI As sensationalism becomes the norm and art comes with ideological baggage, the subtle irreverence of C. Jagdish's work is a breath of fresh air. The Curios World of Chinthala Jagdish, his first solo exhibition of sculptures, showcases over 70 contemporary works. The recent pieces traverse Jagdish's early papier mache creations to new media in aluminium and brass. With the skill of a craftsman and the imagination of an artist, Jagdish decodes the foibles of human behaviour. The series, International Experiences, records Jagdish's impressions of the curios customs of the West encountered in his travels: *The Best Man*, *Till Death Do Us Part*, *College Roommates* and *Ladies Who Lunch*. Other series showcased are *Known and Unknown*, a collection of masks, and *Missing* Homage to Distanced Lovers. Celebrating the fecundity of ordinariness, his use of radiant colours is effortless and sophisticated. The show will also mark the launch of a book of the same title, designed and edited by the show's curator Bina Sarkar. At Tao Art Gallery, from September 6 to 25. **by Neha Thirani**

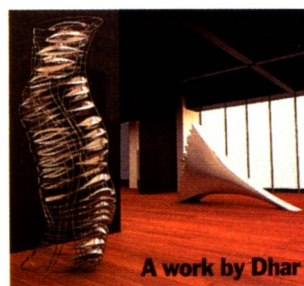


A work by Jagdish

exhibition

Art of Steel

DELHI The traditional metals for artistes have been the bronze, copper, brass and iron but over the years steel has become yet another medium of art. Vishal K. Dhar's exhibiton, Ekant, is an amazing collection of various sculptures—from computer generated data models to bamboo structures and hand-crafted steel. Dhar is an MFA graduate from the University of



A work by Dhar

California, Los Angeles, and was mentored by architect Greg Lynn. His art explores digital ornamentation as a core theme. On display at The Stainless Gallery. From August 27 to September 14.